

House Leva

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"A SORROWFUL WINTER AND A WELCOMING SPRING"

Quick Facts

Status: Count/Countess

Origin: Aicruae (Common, elevated when Brimena caught the queen's attention)

House Name Meaning: Messenger of the Gods

Founded: 8,902 BR

Founder: Brimena Leva

Seat: Jasereiey, Aicruae (communal block living; the family owns all houses on one block)

Faction: Common People Faction

Symbol: Star & Ship, and the bust (head sculpture) of the Aicruaeen Woman (no spirit animal)

Colors: [TBD]

Wealth: 147,000 Rern

Military: 50+ ships (twice House Dajanyi's fleet); crew not limited to family members

Religion: Barqeten

Theme Song: "Be Careful (feat. Laney Jones)" by Tommee Profitt

Status By Era

Pre-Empire Era: Count/Countess. A common-born house elevated to nobility after Brimena Leva attracted the queen's attention with her quick mind. Despite their count-level rank, House Leva is feared and respected for their wealth and naval power.

Solis's Era: Survived. House Leva survived the civil war between Solis and the twins for two reasons: they did not join the twins' side, and they were able to escape the twins' initial coup.

Crandona's Era: [TBD]

Minara's Era: [TBD]

Why They Matter

House Leva is the only matriarchal house in the world, governed by a system called the Divine Matriarch that grants power solely to women. They were common-born, raised up because one woman was too clever to ignore. And from that point forward, every generation was shaped by women who refused to let the house fall, no matter what it cost them.

They're a count family. That's it. No duke title, no vast armies on land. But they have over fifty ships, twice the fleet of House Dajanyi, and a reputation as "the king's thieves" that makes other nobles uneasy. They strike first in trade, politics, and battle. They turn rogues into officers. Pedigree means nothing to them. Results do.

Their wealth, their naval strength, their survival through the civil war: all of it was built and maintained by women. From Brimena, who created the concept of the Divine Matriarch, to Oera, who gave birth to eighteen daughters and married them into noble houses across the world, to Varegua II, who buried her mother, her grandmother, and her aunts before she was fifteen and still held the family together. House Leva is the proof that you don't need noble blood or a standing army to build something that lasts. You need women who won't quit.

Heraldry

The Crest: The House Leva crest takes an unusual oval form rather than a traditional shield shape, its field a deep, rich red. In the center is a woman's profile facing left, rendered in a style similar to a classical cameo or Renaissance portrait. Her skin is brown, her hair a deep purple styled in elaborate curls gathered at the nape of her neck, and she wears a golden yellow headwrap with radiating sections. Her expression is serene, eyes gazing forward toward some distant point. Above her head sits a small golden eight-pointed star, and below her portrait sits a tiny detailed ship with full sails.

Symbolism:

The Woman of Aicruae is the center of everything. Not a goddess. Not a myth. A sailor. A common woman who looked up at the stars and decided she could read

them, who climbed aboard a ship and decided she could steer it, and who came home with enough gold that the queen couldn't ignore her anymore. She's Brimena Leva before she was Brimena Leva. She's Xanti crossing the Quather Sea. She's Varegua I completing that same crossing in two weeks with five people. She's every woman who ran this family for over a thousand years because the Divine Matriarch said women rule and men protect. The crest doesn't show a symbol of the house. It shows the house's religion. The belief that women create the future.

The purple hair marks her as something more than mortal. Purple is the color of royalty, and the Levas have never been royals. They're counts. But the Woman on the crest isn't wearing a crown. She's wearing purple because the house decided, on their own terms, that the women who built this family earned the same honor as queens. Inene Leva placed her two-year-old daughter as heir over six older brothers and dared anyone to argue. Oera gave birth to eighteen daughters and married them across the world. The purple says: we don't need your permission to be sacred.

The golden headwrap ties to House Leva's name. Leva means "Messenger of the Gods." The gold radiating outward from her head is the light of divine communication, the same faith that drives their Barqeten beliefs. Barqeten holds that by simply existing, you worship the gods. The Woman on the crest exists. That's enough. The headwrap also reads as wealth, as warmth, as the practical beauty of a woman who works the sea and still looks like she belongs on a coin.

The eight-pointed star above her head is heaven. The ship below her chin is the sea. She sits between them. That's the whole life of House Leva in one image. Stars for navigation, for faith, for the divine guidance that Brimena believed in when she created the Divine Matriarch. And a ship for the work. The actual, physical, dangerous work of crossing oceans and bringing back 90,000 Rern for the crown and 50,000 Rern in gold artifacts and building a fleet of fifty ships that makes other houses nervous. The star says where they're going. The ship says how they get there.

The red field is sacrifice. The Levas have bled for this house in ways most families can't imagine. Sonua died in childbirth at nineteen. Her daughter Varegua II buried her mother, her grandmother, and her aunts before she turned fifteen. Then Varegua II gave birth to twenty-four sons, one after another, waiting for the

daughter who would continue the Divine Matriarch, and when that daughter finally came, the girl was sick and needed 2,000 Rern in medicine just to survive. Varegua took odd jobs from royals and nobles to pay for it. Red is the cost. Every generation of Leva women has paid it.

The oval shape instead of a traditional shield is its own statement. House Leva doesn't follow the rules other houses follow. They're the only matriarchal house in the world. They live in communal block housing instead of a manor. They recruit crew from outside the family. They trade salt with House Vika and get called "the king's thieves" and don't care. An oval crest for a house that has never fit inside a regular frame.

House Colors: Red, Purple, and Gold. Red for sacrifice, passion, and the blood cost of building something from nothing. Purple for the sacred status of the Divine Matriarch and the women who carry it. Gold for divine guidance, for the wealth they've pulled from every ocean, and for Barqeten faith that says existence itself is worship.

Motto: "A Sorrowful Winter and a Welcoming Spring."

Motto Meaning: The motto is the story of House Leva told in one breath. Every generation faces a winter. Brimena was a common woman in a world that didn't care about common women. Winter. The queen noticed her. Spring. Xanti crossed the Quather Sea and came home rich. Spring. Sonua died at nineteen giving birth. Winter. The baby survived and became Varegua II. Spring. Varegua II lost everyone she loved before she was fifteen. Winter. She held the house together anyway, had twenty-four sons, and finally got her daughter. Spring.

The Levas don't pretend the sorrow isn't real. They don't skip over it or dress it up. The motto puts winter first because that's how life works for this family. The loss comes first. Always. But the second half of the motto isn't a hope. It's a fact. Spring comes. It has come every single time for House Leva, carried on the backs of women who refused to let the line die, who sailed harder, worked longer, and buried their dead without stopping. The spring is welcoming because the Levas have earned it. Every time.

Oera's name means "Joy in Spring." She was the spring. Eighteen daughters. A legacy planted across the world. The motto was written for women like her. And for the winters that came before her and after her. The Levas carry both.

Power & Influence

Source of Power

Naval strength, trade, wealth, and fear. Despite holding only a count-level title, House Leva commands respect and wariness from other noble houses. Their fleet is formidable and their reputation as “the king’s thieves” precedes them.

Internal Power Structure

House Leva follows the Divine Matriarch, the only matriarchal system in the world, providing power solely to women. Brimena Leva created the concept, believing that because women have the ability to create life, they were superior to men. Women rule. Men guide them and protect the children.

Military Forces

50+ ships, twice the size of House Dajanyi’s fleet. Their crew is not limited to family members, meaning they can recruit broadly. Despite their wealth and weaponry, their power is still limited by their count-level rank. They are feared and respected regardless.

Lands & Income

Seat: Jasereiey, Aicruae (Solis’s Era). The family lives in communal block housing, owning all houses on one block.

Key industries: [TBD]. Holds a business alliance with House Vika for salt trading.

Alliances & Rivalries

Allied Houses

House Vika (Business Alliance). House Vika initiated a partnership in a salt trading business owned by House Leva.

House Dajanyi (Marriage Connections). Five of Oera Leva’s eighteen daughters married into House Dajanyi.

Rival Houses

[TBD]

House Culture

Religion

Barqeten.

Traditions

[TBD]

Values

[TBD]

Reputation

Regarded as "the king's thieves." Respected for their wealth but viewed skeptically, similar to House Dajanyi. The house also has historical connections to the UIB in Southern Aicruae, which likely does nothing to soften that reputation.

How Others Perceive Them

[TBD]

History

Founding (8,902 BR)

Brimena Leva, the daughter of a local lord, attracted the attention of the queen with her quick mind. The queen gave her a noble title and put her in charge of the royal fleet and a group of sailors. Brimena then founded House Leva and created the concept of the Divine Matriarch, believing that women, because they can create life, were meant to rule, and that men were meant to guide them and protect the children. The name Brimena means "bridge."

Rise to Power

[TBD]

Major Achievements

Two Quarti Medals: Xanti Leva earned the first for her voyage to the Quather Sea, which secured 90,000 Rern for the royal family. Varegua Leva I earned the second after recovering 50,000 Rern worth of gold artifacts from locations across the world and completing the voyage of the Quather and Fetora seas in two weeks with a crew of five.

Major Disgraces

[TBD]

Notable Members

Listed chronologically, from the house's origins to its most recent known generation.

Brimena Leva (8,942 BR – 8,872 BR)

Founder of House Leva | Creator of the Divine Matriarch

Name meaning: Bridge

The daughter of a local lord who attracted the attention of the queen with her quick mind. She was given a noble title and placed in charge of the royal fleet and a group of sailors. Brimena founded House Leva and created the concept of the Divine Matriarch. She believed that because women have the ability to create life, they were superior to men. Women were meant to rule. Men were meant to guide them and protect the children.

Xanti Leva (8,527 BR – 8,501 BR)

First Quarti Medal Recipient

Name meaning: Ocean / Body of Water

Xanti received the Quarti Medal for her voyage to the Quather Sea, which secured over 90,000 Rern for the royal family. She was deeply respected. So respected, in fact, that the queen had two portraits composed entirely of gold commissioned of her. One was given to the Leva family (a copy of the original) and the other was hung in the royal treasury.

Varegua Leva I (8,249 BR – 8,185 BR)

Second Quarti Medal Recipient

Name meaning: A Tall Plant

The second Quarti Medal holder. Varegua I recovered 50,000 Rern worth of gold artifacts from various locations all over the world and returned them to the Leva family and the royal family. She accomplished the impossible: her voyage of the Quather Sea and Fetora Sea was completed in two weeks, with a crew of only five people.

Inene Leva (7,705 BR – 7,619 BR)

Enforcer of the Divine Matriarch

Name meaning: Ice

Inene was known for her many male lovers, twenty-three in total, who fathered her seven children. Like her ancestor Brimena, she believed that men were meant to guide women in powerful positions. And she was the one to truly enforce the Divine Matriarch, placing her two-year-old daughter as her heir over her six older brothers.

Oera Leva (7,651 BR – 7,570 BR)

"High Mother"

Name meaning: Joy in Spring

Oera was the daughter of Inene Leva and House Leva's literal divine matriarch. During her lifetime she took several husbands, like her mother, and gave birth to eighteen children. All girls. For this she is called "High Mother." Her daughters married into House Dajanyi and lesser houses across the world.

Sonua Leva (7,626 BR – 7,607 BR)

Name meaning: Wave

The granddaughter of Oera, born to Oera's firstborn daughter. Sonua was deeply loved by her grandmother and by House Leva, but she died in childbirth at age 19. Her daughter survived. Oera named the surviving girl Varegua Leva II because she resembled their famous ancestor.

Varegua Leva II (7,607 BR – 7,504 BR)

Name meaning: A Tall Plant

Named by her great-grandmother Oera after the famous ancestor she resembled. Varegua II's life was filled with tragedy. She lost her mother, her grandmother, and several of her aunts before she had reached fifteen. She carried the weight of securing the family's legacy: she needed to marry and give birth to another divine matriarch. She gave birth to twenty-four sons before finally having a girl, who was weak and needed expensive medicine to live (around 2,000 Rern worth of medicine). Varegua II took odd jobs from the royal family and other nobles to afford the treatment, which thankfully worked.

Succession of House Leva

[TBD: Head-of-house dates for House Leva are not yet established.]

Strengths & Weaknesses

Known For

[TBD]

What They Lack

[TBD]

Vulnerabilities

[TBD]

Role in Narrative

Book Appearances: [TBD]

Plot Significance: [TBD]

Key Members in Story: [TBD]

Cross-References

House Vika, House Dajanyi, Quarti Medal, Quather Sea, Fetora Sea, Barqeten, Divine Matriarch, Jasereiey, Aicruae, UIB, Southern Aicruae, Common People Faction, Rern

Keywords

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